

Furman University Society of Physics Students Constitution

CONSTITUTION OF SOCIETY OF PHYSICS STUDENTS

ARTICLE I. NAME

The name of this organization shall be “Society of Physics Students”.

ARTICLE II. OBJECTIVES

The objectives of the Society of Physics Students shall be to: - encourage and assist students interested in physics and astronomy to develop the knowledge, competence, enthusiasm, and social responsibilities that are essential to the advancement of physics and astronomy; - stimulate interest in advanced study and research in physics; - develop collegiality among physics students and faculty members; and - promote public interest in physics.

ARTICLE III. BYLAWS

Section A: Elections

Clause 1: The Executive Committee of the Society shall be the President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Public Relations Chair, and Astronomy Chair. Elective officers may not serve more than two consecutive full terms on the Executive Committee in the same office.

Clause 2: All officers must be a declared Physics or Applied Physics Major, except for the Astronomy Chair and the Public Relations Chair.

Clause 3: The term of office shall be from April to March of a given year.

Clause 4: Election of officers shall be held annually in April. At least two weeks’ notice shall be given before the election. Elections will be held on a digital ballot sent to the general membership.

Clause 5: Any officer may be removed from an executive position by a two-thirds vote of the Executive Committee. Any officer removed may appeal to the general membership within a two week period. Said officer shall be considered reinstated with two-thirds approval of the voting members.

Clause 6: If the President is unable to complete their term or removed from office, the Executive Committee will vote in a new President.

Clause 7: Any vacancy which may occur in an office shall be filled by appointment by the President pending ratification at the next executive meeting. This appointment may take effect after any ongoing appeals.

Section B: Meetings

Clause 1: Executive meetings shall be held every week at a regular time, designated by the Executive Committee. This may be cancelled by the President with 24 hours of notice.

Clause 2: At least 7 days' notice shall be given for each general meeting.

Clause 3: Special or emergency meetings may be called with less than 1 days' notice by any member of the Executive Committee.

Clause 4: Each meeting shall include a quorum, order of business, and disposition of the minutes.

Clause 5: A quorum for general meetings is 25% of the membership.

Clause 6: Executive members must not miss 3 meetings (general or executive) in a row. Failure to meet attendance policy will result in removal from the Executive Committee. People removed from their position are not eligible for reinstatement.

Article IV. OFFICERS

Section A: The President

1. The President shall be the chief executive officer.
2. The President, with approval of the Executive Committee, directs the budget.
3. Vacancies in offices will be filled by appointment of the President after consultation with the Executive Committee.

Section B: The Vice President

1. The Vice President shall be the parliamentarian for the organization.
2. The Vice President shall assume the duties of the President in the absence of the President.
3. The Vice President will keep and have available current copies of the constitution.
4. The Vice President will be responsible for scheduling programs.

Section C: The Secretary

1. The Secretary shall be responsible for keeping the minutes of all meetings.
2. The Secretary will provide a copy of the minutes for each officer and keep a master file.
3. The Secretary shall maintain a complete and accurate account of attendance and membership status.

Section D: Treasurer

1. The Treasurer shall keep a current record of all financial transactions.
2. The Treasurer shall develop quarterly reports containing a list of all receipts and disbursements and distribute them among the executive membership.
3. The Treasurer will be responsible for checking the accuracy of all bills and invoices and paying them correctly and on time.

Section E: Astronomy Chair

1. The Astronomy Chair is responsible for organizing all astronomy related events.
2. The Astronomy Chair will lead astronomy meetings and SPS-sponsored planetarium shows.

Section F: Public Relations Chair

1. The Public Relations Chair is responsible for updating members on pertinent news.
2. The Public Relations Chair will develop marketing material for events (flyers, posters, etc).
3. The Public Relations Chair maintains SPS social media platforms.

Section G: Advisor

1. The advisor shall be a physics faculty or staff member and assists the group in their execution of roles and responsibilities. They must be approved by the chair of the physics department.
2. The advisor shall provide feedback to the organization regarding its operation and functioning.
3. The advisor shall serve as a resource, and provide liaison among the Chapter, the department responsible for physics instructions, and the national office.
4. The advisor should provide advice upon request, and also should share knowledge, expertise, and experience with the group.
5. The advisor will be a nonvoting member of the organization.

Article V. FURMAN CONDUCT CLAUSE

Organizations may not address a member's violations of university policy via internal standards boards or other accountability mechanisms without prior approval of the Dean of Students Office. Conduct expectations unique to membership in the organization and that do not overlap or otherwise interfere with university authority may be addressed with the written approval of the AVP/Dean of Students or designee. Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so with written approval of the university.